

Zero Sum RPG Scenario: 002 - Ghost Flight 88



Real-World Inspiration

Based on the rise of autonomous drone cargo flights and GPS-spoofing incidents in commercial aviation.

Background

A fully autonomous heavy-lift cargo plane (Flight 88) carrying a classified quantum-decryption prototype is crossing the Pacific. A rogue state actor has successfully GPS-spoofed the plane, causing it to alter course toward a black-site airstrip. The players must board the plane mid-flight from a stealth transport, regain manual control, and parachute the prototype out over international waters before the rogue state intercepts it.

The Zero Sum Twist

There are no human pilots. The cockpit is sealed and filled with nitrogen to prevent fires. Furthermore, the plane's cargo hold is packed with high-explosive munitions. A single gunshot or stray spark in the cargo bay will obliterate the entire aircraft. The players must engage the rogue state's stowaway hijackers in absolute silence, using only non-lethal or kinetic melee weapons.

Zero Sum Consistency Matrix (ZSCM)

- **E (Lethality Expectation) = 8:** If a gun is fired, everyone dies. The hijackers know this, creating a brutal hand-to-hand environment.
- **R (Resource Scarcity) = 9:** You are 30,000 feet in the air. There is no backup, no exfil, and no extra gear.
- **I (Intel Asymmetry) = 5:** The players have the plane's schematics, but the hijackers have root access to the plane's internal sensors.
- **D (Collateral Damage Risk) = 6:** A crash over the ocean minimizes civilian casualties, but guarantees total mission failure.

Total ZSCM Score = 28/30 (Extremely Lethal).

Key NPCs & Obstacles

- **The "Spetsnaz" Stowaways:** Highly trained, utterly silent hand-to-hand combatants waiting in the dark cargo hold.
- **The Nitrogen Cockpit:** Breaking into the cockpit means dealing with an oxygen-deprived environment. Players have 60 seconds of breathable air unless they bring localized oxygen supplies.

Objective

1. Board the plane mid-flight (requires high Kinetics/Piloting checks).
2. Neutralize the hijackers without using firearms.
3. Access the nitrogen-flooded cockpit to override the autopilot.
4. Drop the payload and HALO jump out before the plane enters hostile airspace.